

UTKARSH RANJAN PATHAK

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PROFILE

M.A. candidate in Conflict Analysis and Peacebuilding (Jamia Millia Islamia, 2027) with demonstrated experience in UN-affiliated programming, civil-military relations, and South Asian security research. Former Senior Under Officer, National Cadet Corps, with proven leadership across humanitarian response and community mobilisation. Competitively selected participant at the Raisina Dialogue 2026 and recipient of the Best Group Project Award at the Ashtalakshmi Darshan Youth Exchange Programme (IIT Guwahati / Ministry of DoNER). Conference paper presenter at JNU on Operation Sindoor and South Asian deterrence. Certified across UNSSC, UNITAR, and USIP-affiliated training programmes. Fluent in six languages; Arabic currently under study. Seeking to contribute evidence-based conflict analysis and peacebuilding practice to international peace, security, and development organisations.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Conflict Analysis and Peacebuilding · Civil-Military Relations · Community Resilience · South Asian Security · Internal Security and Counter-Terrorism · Governance in Conflict-Affected Regions · Children and Armed Conflict · Human Security · Conflict Transformation · Peacebuilding Practice · Reconciliation ·

EDUCATION

Master of Arts - Conflict Analysis and Peacebuilding

Jamia Millia Islamia, New Delhi

2025-2027 (Expected)

Coursework: Conflict Analysis · Peacebuilding Theory and Practice · State, Citizenship and Governance · Multilateral Institutions and Conflict Resolution · Research Methodology · International Relations and Security Studies

Bachelor of Commerce (Honours) | Patna University, Patna

2015-2018

PROFESSIONAL & FIELD EXPERIENCE

Online Volunteer - Youth Engagement & Digital Health Awareness |

UNFPA India · JustAsk! Initiative (via UN Volunteers)

July–November 2025

- Expanded youth awareness of sexual and reproductive health rights by designing and facilitating participatory community engagement sessions, contributing to programme outreach measured against UNFPA's adolescent health indicators.
- Supported gender-mainstreaming efforts by integrating gender-sensitive communication frameworks into outreach materials and coordinating with civil society partners to strengthen inter-agency delivery.
- Applied monitoring and evaluation principles to track session outcomes and compile field reports, strengthening evidence-based programme documentation across the initiative.
- Contributed to the JustAsk! AI Chatbot initiative, which was recognised as a Finalist among 17 outstanding innovations across the United Nations at the UN 2.0 Awards, empowering approximately one million adolescents with safe reproductive health information.

Senior Under Officer

National Cadet Corps (NCC) · Ministry of Defence, Government of India.

2018–2021

- Led a cadet cohort through Combined Annual Training Camps (2018, 2019), developing civil-military interface skills and community resilience capacities directly applicable to peacebuilding practice.
- Coordinated humanitarian service during the COVID-19 pandemic response; awarded Certificate of Merit by NCC for community mobilisation and stakeholder engagement under crisis conditions (2020).
- Awarded Certificate of Merit for contributions to the Aatmanirbhar Bharat Campaign (2020).
- Attained NCC 'C' Certificate with Grade A -the highest national proficiency standard reflecting sustained leadership performance across the full NCC programme.

- Recognised for voluntary humanitarian service; awarded Blood Donation Certificate by the Indian Red Cross Society (2018) during NCC service activities.

POLICY & INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS ENGAGEMENT

Selected Participant - Raisina Dialogue 2026

Observer Research Foundation (ORF) / Ministry of External Affairs, Government of India 6-7 March 2026

- Competitively selected from over 5,000 student applicants representing 110 universities across 95 cities nationwide to attend India's premier multilateral geopolitics conference at Taj Palace Hotel, Diplomatic Enclave, New Delhi.
- Engaged with senior diplomats, policymakers, and strategic researchers in plenary sessions and working-group discussions on international security, deterrence, governance, and emerging technologies.
- Strengthened inter-agency and cross-sectoral policy analysis skills through direct engagement with delegations representing the international security community.

Participant & Award Recipient - Ashtalakshmi Darshan Youth Exchange Programme |

North Eastern Council (NEC) / Ministry of DoNER, Govt. of India · Hosted by IIT Guwahati 15-28 March 2026

- Selected to participate in a 14-day residential youth exchange programme hosted by IIT Guwahati, organised by the North Eastern Council under the Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region (DoNER), Government of India, engaging with the culture, ecology, and governance of Northeast India.
- Awarded Second Position - Best Group Project Award for research on Traditional Ecological Knowledge of Tribal Communities, demonstrating applied research, intercultural collaboration, and community-based analysis skills directly relevant to peacebuilding and conflict-affected societies.

PUBLICATIONS & PRESENTATIONS

Conference Papers

Pathak, U. R. (2026). Calibrated escalation: Operation Sindoor and the transformation of deterrence in South Asia. Paper presented at the 6th HHRS International Conference, Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi, February 2026.

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

Children and Armed Conflict Primer –

UN System Staff College/Office of the SRSG-CAAC/Government of Malta. June 2026

Conflict Series - Levels I, II & III - UNITAR - United Nations Institute for Training and Research June 2025

Foundational Course on Counter-Terrorism in the UN System - UNITAR × UNOCT (E-learning) June 2025

Conflict Sensitivity - Gandhi-King Global Academy / United States Institute of Peace (USIP) June 2026

Fundamentals of Peace Mediation - Gandhi-King Global Academy (USIP) June 2025

Introduction to Peacebuilding 101 - Gandhi-King Global Academy (USIP) June 2025

Global Diplomacy: The UN in the World - University of London & SOAS UoL (via Coursera) January 2026

Understanding Research Methods - University of London (via Coursera) June 2026

RESEARCH METHODS & SKILLS

Research Methods: Qualitative Research · Case Study Methodology · Policy Analysis · Document Analysis · Literature Review

Communication: Academic Writing · Policy Writing · Report Writing · Research Presentation

LANGUAGES

Hindi	Native (Speaking, Reading, Writing)
Bhojpuri	Fluent (Speaking, Reading, Writing)
English	Fluent (Speaking, Reading, Writing)
Marwari	Fluent (Speaking, Reading, Writing)
Gujarati	Basic (Speaking, Reading, Writing)
Spanish	Basic (Speaking, Reading, Writing)
Arabic	Beginner (Currently studying - UN official language)